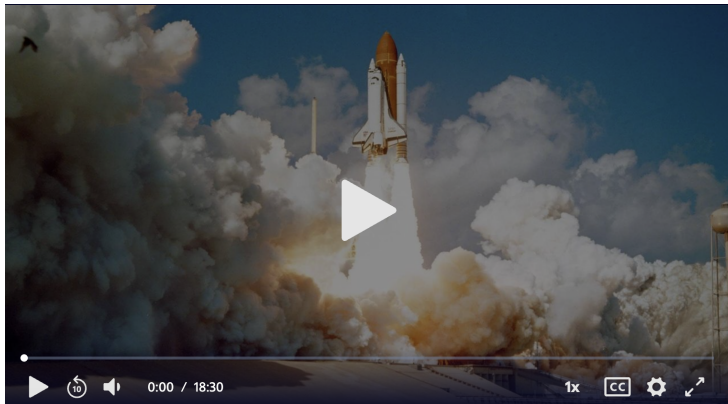


LIES, DAMN LIES, AND DATA

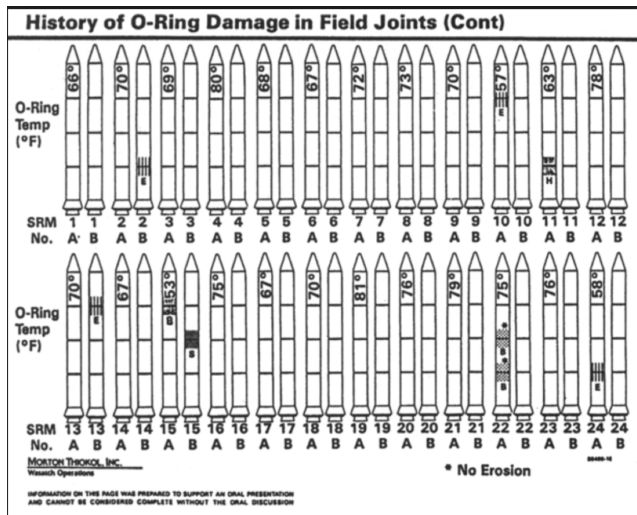
Data Analysis for Journalism and Political Communication
(Spring 2026)

Prof. Bell

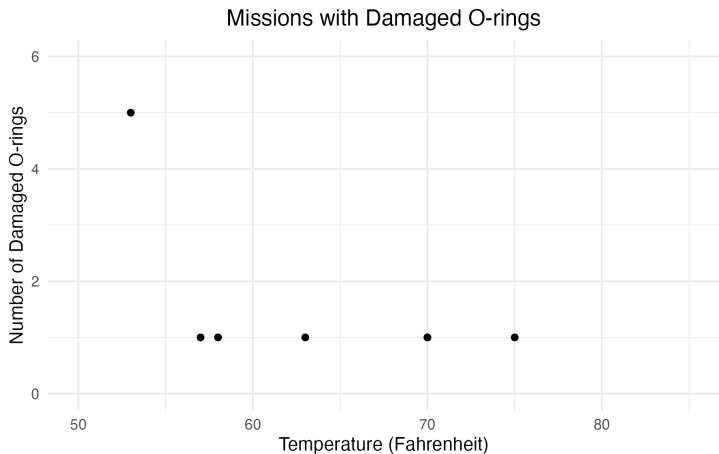
STORY #1: THE CHALLENGER DISASTER



STORY #1: THE CHALLENGER DISASTER

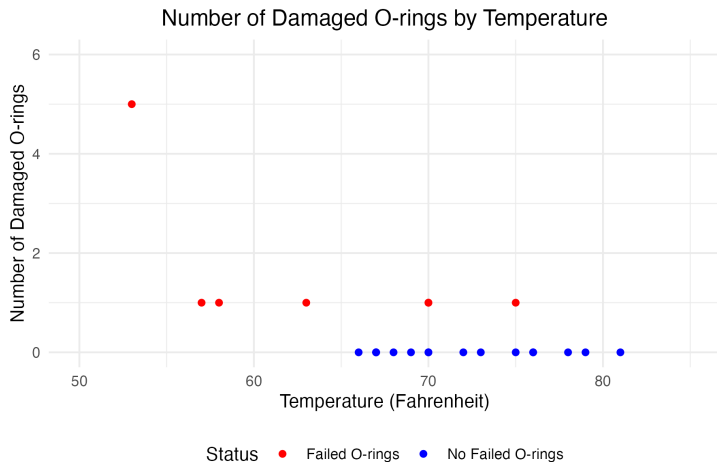


STORY #1: THE CHALLENGER DISASTER



Source: {openintro} R package

STORY #1: THE CHALLENGER DISASTER



STORY #2: IN“DEBT”ED TO EXCEL



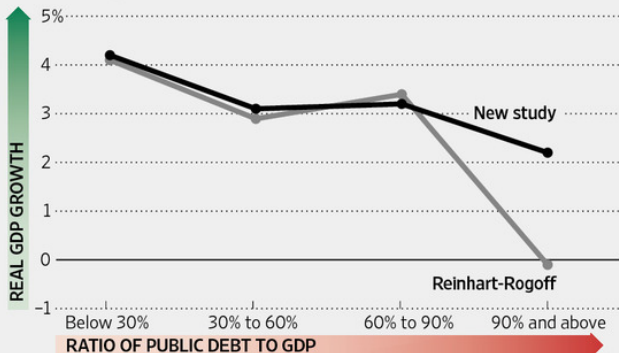
STORY #2: IN“DEBT”ED TO EXCEL

	B	C	I	J	K	L	M
2			Real GDP growth				
3			Debt/GDP				
4	Country	Coverage	30 or less	30 to 60	60 to 90	90 or above	30 or less
26			3.7	3.0	3.5	1.7	5.5
27	Minimum		1.6	0.3	1.3	-1.8	0.8
28	Maximum		5.4	4.9	10.2	3.6	13.3
29							
30	US	1946-2009	n.a.	3.4	3.3	-2.0	n.a.
31	UK	1946-2009	n.a.	2.4	2.5	2.4	n.a.
32	Sweden	1946-2009	3.6	2.9	2.7	n.a.	6.3
33	Spain	1946-2009	1.5	3.4	4.2	n.a.	9.9
34	Portugal	1952-2009	4.8	2.5	0.3	n.a.	7.9
35	New Zealand	1948-2009	2.5	2.9	3.9	-7.9	2.6
36	Netherlands	1956-2009	4.1	2.7	1.1	n.a.	6.4
37	Norway	1947-2009	3.4	5.1	n.a.	n.a.	5.4
38	Japan	1946-2009	7.0	4.0	1.0	0.7	7.0
39	Italy	1951-2009	5.4	2.1	1.8	1.0	5.6
40	Ireland	1948-2009	4.4	4.5	4.0	2.4	2.9
41	Greece	1970-2009	4.0	0.3	2.7	2.9	13.3
42	Germany	1946-2009	3.9	0.9	n.a.	n.a.	3.2
43	France	1949-2009	4.9	2.7	3.0	n.a.	5.2
44	Finland	1946-2009	3.8	2.4	5.5	n.a.	7.0
45	Denmark	1950-2009	3.5	1.7	2.4	n.a.	5.6
46	Canada	1951-2009	1.9	3.6	4.1	n.a.	2.2
47	Belgium	1947-2009	n.a.	4.2	3.1	2.6	n.a.
48	Austria	1948-2009	5.2	3.3	-3.8	n.a.	5.7
49	Australia	1951-2009	3.2	4.9	4.0	n.a.	5.9
50							
51			4.1	2.8	2.8	=AVERAGE(L30:L44)	

STORY #2: IN“DEBT”ED TO EXCEL

This Time It's Different

Economists found less of a correlation between heavy debt loads and slower growth than in an much-cited study by Carmen Reinhart and Kenneth Rogoff.



Source: Political Economy Research Institute; Thomas Herndon, Michael Ash and Robert Pollin
The Wall Street Journal

STORY #3



STORY #3: LYING ABOUT LYING

RESEARCH ARTICLE | PSYCHOLOGICAL AND COGNITIVE SCIENCES | 



RETRACTED: Signing at the beginning makes ethics salient and decreases dishonest self-reports in comparison to signing at the end

[Lisa L. Shu](#), [Nina Mazar](#) , [Francesca Gino](#), [Dan Ariely](#), and [Max H. Bazerman](#)  [Authors Info & Affiliations](#)

Edited by Daniel Kahneman, Princeton University, Princeton, NJ, and approved July 23, 2012 (received for review June 11, 2012)

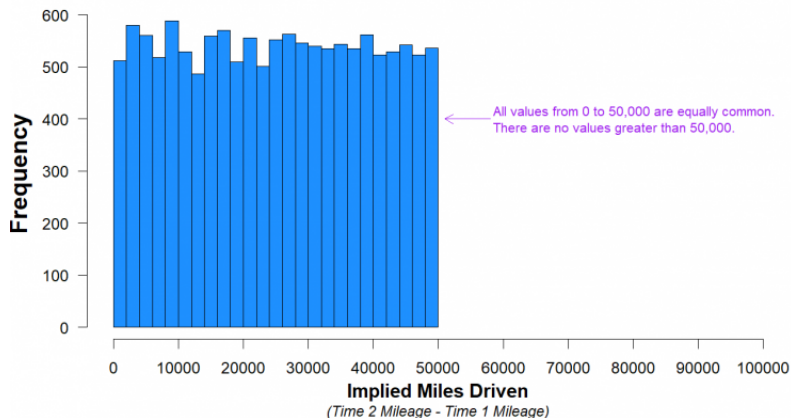
August 27, 2012 | 109 (38) 15197-15200 | <https://doi.org/10.1073/pnas.1209746109>

THIS ARTICLE HAS BEEN RETRACTED +

VIEW RELATED CONTENT +

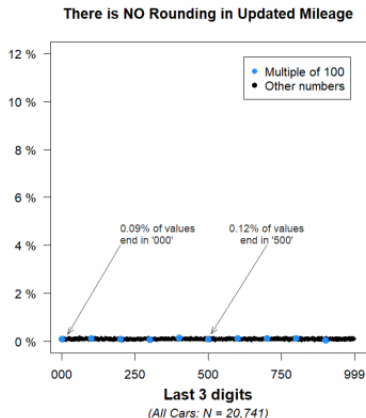
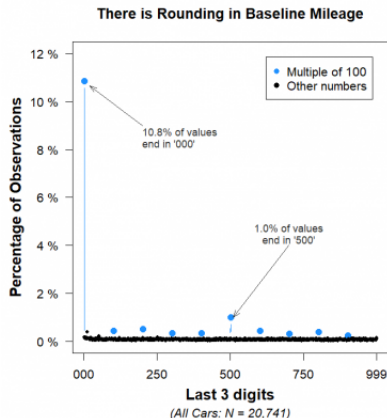
STORY #3: LYING ABOUT LYING

Figure 1. Histogram of Miles Driven - Car #1 (N=13,488)



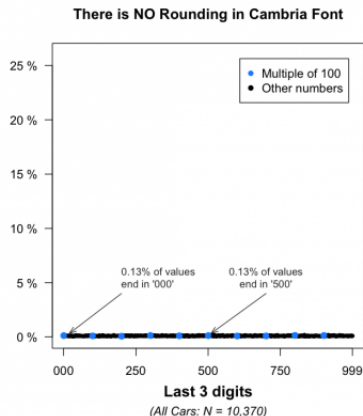
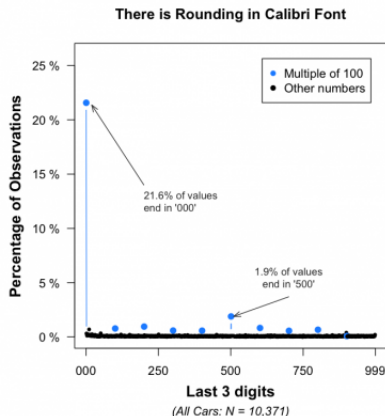
STORY #3: LYING ABOUT LYING

Figure 3. Last Three Digits at Baseline (Time 1) vs Updated (Time 2)



STORY #3: LYING ABOUT LYING

Figure 6. Last Three Digits at Baseline: Calibri vs. Cambria



STORY #4: NEW IS NOT ALWAYS BETTER



STORY #5: ZILLOW'S \$880 MILLION MISTAKE

Arizona · Chandler · 85249 · Sun River · 6630 S Nash Way



Owned by Zillow

Why buy a home owned by Zillow? We offer peace of mind and convenience, with a free inspection summary, up to \$1500 in savings at closing, and a streamlined process from offer to close.

[Get your free inspection summary](#)

6630 S Nash Way
Chandler, AZ 85249

4 beds · 2 baths · 2,750 sqft

● **COMING SOON**
\$425,000
Zestimate®: \$414,233

Expected on market May 28.

Schedule Tour

TUE May 22	WED May 23	THU May 24
----------------------	----------------------	----------------------

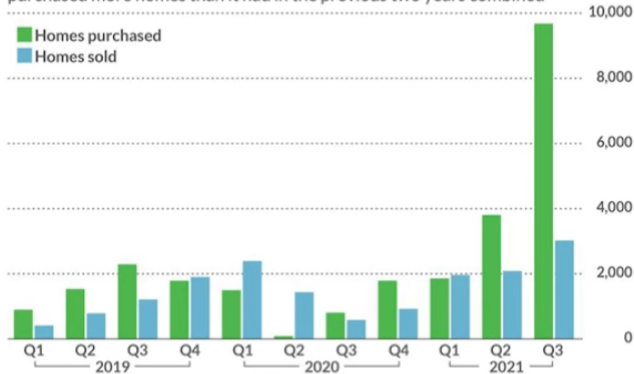
Choose a time

[Schedule Tour](#)

STORY #5: ZILLOW'S \$880 MILLION MISTAKE

Zillow's home-buying spree

In the two quarters before announcing the end of its Zillow Offers business, Zillow purchased more homes than it had in the previous two years combined



Source: Zillow Group